Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Orchard House Residential Care Home

Orchard House Residential Home, 3-7, Colcot Road, Barry, CF62 8HJ

01446720876

The inspection visits for this service took place between 18/06/2026 and 22/06/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Northcote Developments Ltd
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care
Registered places:	40
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider promotes, anticipates, identifies, and meets the Welsh language and culture needs of people.

Ratings:

Well-being	Excellent
Care & Support	Excellent
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Orchard House, situated in Barry, offers residential accommodation for up to 40 individuals. This inspection was unannounced. Feedback from people living and visiting the service consistently indicate very high levels of satisfaction and overall happiness with the service. Staff are praised for their attentiveness, compassion, and respect, and are consistently recognised for going above and beyond in delivering person-centred care.

People live in accommodation that is suitably aligned with their assessed needs. The premises are maintained to a good standard of cleanliness, supported by robust infection prevention and control procedures. The environment is fit for its intended purpose, offering a range of communal areas that facilitate both social interaction and privacy, with required refurbishment works undertaken on an ongoing basis.

Management demonstrate good oversight of the service through regular audits and up-to-date policies. The Responsible Individual (RI) is available at the service on a daily basis, supporting effective monitoring and governance. Recruitment processes are robust and compliant, ensuring

staff are properly vetted and suitable for their roles. There is clear management of staff supervision and training. Care records are regularly updated to reflect changes in individuals' health needs, associated risks, and review outcomes. The provider actively invests in the service and implements improvements when needed.

Findings:

Well-being — Excellent

People are protected from harm and abuse. The home environment is safe and promotes the wellbeing of individuals by minimising risks of harm. Robust and well-organized systems ensure the premises are cleaned and maintained to a high standard. All services and equipment are regularly tested and appropriately serviced. Staff adhere to infection prevention and control procedures, contributing to a hygienic and secure setting. Care staff are recruited safely as pre-employment checks are completed correctly. There is a system to renew Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) certificates when required. Care staff, where required are registered with Social Care Wales, the workforce regulator. Documentation and medication are stored securely.

People experience positive and respectful relationships with care staff. Throughout the inspection visit, staff were observed interacting with people in a kind and friendly manner. Care staff responded promptly to people's needs, offering reassurance and support as required. People are extremely well-presented and appeared content and happy, either engaging in activities or enjoying quiet time alone. Feedback from people living at the home was extremely positive. People expressed that they feel happy residing there and described the staff as exceptionally kind and attentive. Comments include, *"I really couldn't ask for more,"* and *"staff are amazing here, I have no worries."* Feedback from provider audits and questionnaires consistently evidence that families rate the service as "outstanding."

People receive timely care, supported by staffing levels that are consistently maintained at a good standard. This allows care staff to perform their roles effectively while building positive relationships with people and their families. Personal care plans are in place to support care staff in delivering appropriate care and are regularly reviewed to ensure they remain up to date and responsive to individuals' needs. Individuals have suitable access to healthcare services when needed, and medications are administered in accordance with prescribed guidance. The Responsible Individual (RI) provides strong oversight of the service, carrying out quality assurance monitoring in line with regulatory requirement and also available at the home on a daily basis.

People appear happy and actively involved in activities they enjoy. There is a clear and consistent focus on maintaining family relationships. One person told us, *"My family are welcomed whenever they want to visit; staff always make us feel special."* People spoke positively about the regular programme of activities and visiting entertainers. During our visit, we observed that people have access to personal belongings that reflect their interests and hobbies, and are also encouraged to try new activities, such as flower arranging taking place during the visit. People said they are able to choose where they spend their time and who they spend it with. The environment and excellent garden areas were also seen to have a positive impact on overall well-being.

No formal complaints have been received. However, the service has received a substantial number

of compliments, particularly in relation to the quality of care provided.

Care & Support — Excellent

People told us they feel safe and secure living in the home, and we observed this through people's body language and interactions, including where individuals were not always able to express this for themselves. Documentation confirmed that staff have completed safeguarding training. A safeguarding policy is in place, clearly outlining staff responsibilities in protecting adults from harm, abuse and neglect. We saw people comfortable and at ease in the presence of care staff. People told us, and we observed, that staff engaged are warm kind and respectful, demonstrating an excellent understanding of individual needs and how best to respond. We observed that care staff showed sensitivity and provided appropriate support when individuals experienced difficulties with decision-making or communication. We saw care staff offering reassurance and encouragement while effectively anticipating their needs, particularly for those who were unable to express this themselves.

People can be assured they have autonomy over their lives and are supported to make informed decisions about their daily routines. Personal preferences are acknowledged and respected, with people encouraged to take part in activities that are meaningful to them. The service benefits from a dedicated activities coordinator who provides a structured programme five days a week. This includes celebrating special occasions, fostering links with local schools and community groups, and arranging visits from external entertainers. In addition, care staff support more informal, ad hoc activities during each shift to ensure people remain engaged throughout the day. Regular outings are organised enabling residents to access local amenities and enjoy trips to places such as the seaside and community coffee mornings. During our visit, we observed people taking great enjoyment in spending time with the visiting dogs, which attend the home daily. There was a clear sense of delight and frequent laughter evident throughout the day. Feedback from residents/visitors was consistently positive. One individual shared, *"I cannot say anything other than the home exceeds in everything, moving here was such a shock at first, but really I've settled and its fabulous."* We observed the lunchtime meal and saw that people were thoroughly enjoying the food served. The chef also informed us that fresh produce is delivered to the home every day.

People have access to other services to support their ongoing health and well-being. Care documentation evidenced timely referrals to relevant healthcare professionals, including opticians, dentists and GPs. Personal plans contain the required information and accurately reflect the daily needs, preferences and wishes of individuals living at the home. We observed that care workers are highly attentive, anticipate individuals' needs and provide excellent responsive support. Personal plans are reviewed and updated as required. When individuals experience difficulties with decision-making, the service demonstrates good practice by ensuring appropriate applications are submitted to the relevant authority, supporting the inclusion of the person's wishes in decision-making processes. Medication management systems within the home are robust, with clear procedures in place for storage and administration. These processes are well organised and consistently maintained to ensure accuracy and safety.

Environment — Good

People are supported in a clean and extremely homely environment. Bedrooms are personalised with items of the individual's choice, including their own belongings. The home provides several small communal areas, as well as a pleasant dining space where we observed people enjoying activities together. During our visit, we found the home to be consistently clean and fresh throughout. Visitors were warmly welcomed, and people we spoke to highlighted how important these visits are for maintaining connections with their relatives. The gardens are beautifully presented and well maintained. People told us they enjoy spending time outdoors, particularly in warmer weather, and we saw that the garden is easily accessible for everyone. We saw people taking the opportunity to spend time outside during our visit and enjoying drinks and chatter throughout the day. People spoke positively and excitedly about a recent garden party, which was enjoyed by all. We observed people are safe, happy and well supported.

There are effective systems in place for monitoring and maintaining both the environment and equipment. Maintenance staff ensures that all facilities and equipment are regularly inspected, serviced, and tested. External contractors are engaged to undertake specialist checks, including gas electrical safety and lift safety. Repairs are generally addressed promptly, and a planned redecoration programme supports a good standard of presentation within the home. However, at this time certain areas of the home would benefit from refurbishment to further improve the environment; the provider has confirmed that these enhancements are currently underway. The Food Standards Agency has awarded a rating of three* (satisfactory) for its catering provision, the provider told us the required actions have been met.

Effective systems are in place to promote public safety and minimise the risk of cross-infection. Staff have access to appropriate personal protective equipment (PPE) and demonstrate a clear understanding of its correct use and disposal. All staff receive training in infection prevention and control and recognise its importance in safeguarding people. Robust oversight arrangements are established, ensuring staff consistently follow current infection control guidance. People are further protected through effective security measures, including keypad entry systems and controlled access for visitors. A visitors' book is maintained in line with fire safety procedures, and identity checks are undertaken for all visitors prior to entry.

The service provides suitable accommodation for people living in, working in, and visiting the home. Management demonstrates a clear commitment to continuous development and improvement for the benefit of those residing there. People experience an extremely strong sense of belonging, supported by the provider's efforts to create a homely and welcoming environment that meets individual needs. The home is overall well presented, and both residents their families and visitors appreciate its traditional style, which contributes positively to overall well-being.

Leadership & Management — Good

People are supported by care staff who are appropriately trained and recruited safely. Care staff are extremely happy working at the service and told us they feel valued and supported by both the manager and RI. We looked at a selection of staff recruitment documentation and found they contained all the required information including identification and full employment history. We saw evidence that pre-employment checks including DBS certificates and references are sought prior to employment commencing to ensure that all staff are suitably qualified and fit to work with vulnerable people. Individuals using the service and their relatives consistently praised the quality of care, with one stating *"I can't fault it here, the care staff are kind and helpful."*

People benefit from strong leadership and effective management within the service. Orchard House is a registered service with robust oversight by the Responsible Individual (RI) and supported by a manager who is registered with Social Care Wales. The RI undertakes maintains an active, visible presence, engaging with both individuals receiving care and staff in an approachable manner. Clear and comprehensive policies and procedures support the day-to-day running of the service and provide staff with well-defined guidance on their roles and responsibilities. The manager has a thorough understanding of their legal duties in safeguarding vulnerable individuals and makes timely referrals to the local authority when required. Since the last inspection the manager has received some formal supervision with the RI, we discussed this needs to be strengthened further to meet regulatory requirements. We were told this would be addressed immediately.

The provider supports staff development at all levels. Care staff complete a comprehensive induction programme, which includes opportunities to shadow more experienced colleagues. Their competency is assessed before they begin working independently. Training is provided in line with the responsibilities of their roles. One staff member commented, *"We are an excellent team here now, there is really good staff morale. We all work together to ensure residents' needs are met."* Regular supervision sessions take place between staff and management; several care staff told us they feel extremely well supported. Staff turnover remains low, which many attribute to the positive working environment. Several care staff told us they have worked at the home for many years and *"wouldn't consider working anywhere else."*

Quality assurance processes are carried out in accordance with regulatory requirements, reflecting the provider's commitment to delivering high-quality care and implementing improvements where needed. Individuals are provided with detailed information about the service, including guidance on how to raise concerns or make complaints should they be dissatisfied. The home's Statement of Purpose (SoP) is regularly reviewed and updated as necessary. This document is essential as it outlines the scope of care provision specifying who can receive care, as well as how, where, and when that care is delivered. The management team demonstrate strong and effective leadership, placing people at the centre of a well-organised and smoothly operated service that is valued and enjoyed. The home performs to an excellent standard, truly excelling in providing a "home from

home” environment that is warm, cosy, and comforting.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Welsh Government © Crown copyright 2026.
You may use and re-use the information featured in this publication (not including logos) free of charge in any format or medium, under the terms of the Open Government License. You can view the Open Government License, on the National Archives website or you can write to the Information Policy Team, The National Archives, Kew, London TW9 4DU, or email: psi@nationalarchives.gov.uk
You must reproduce our material accurately and not use it in a misleading context.